

- Submit the purchase request for approval.
 - Follow up with internal approvers as needed.
- After submitting the Professional Services Request Form, it will apply to your Cart.
- Go into the Review Cart section and enter the information on the purchase request with the Professional Services Request Form questions already populated and added to the purchase request.
- Notes:
 - For Consulting, do not specify anyone for the "on behalf of" field. PS Project Coordinator will initiate the new purchase request.
 - For Training, PS Education Services Manager will initiate a new purchase request and specify the PS Project Coordinator for the "on behalf of" field.
- General Info section:
 - Description of Purchase- PS Partner Sub Contractor Agreement
 - Add Agreements in the Attachments
 - Partner SOW
- If work is ongoing past the Service End Date and invoices are processed on a monthly basis, the PO will remain open. If for any reason the PO is systematically closed, a request via Accounts Payable Slack Channel accountspayable will need to be sent to A/P to have the PO re-opened.

Purchase Order Process

- After all approvers approve the purchase request, an associated Coupa PO will be created.
- Partner/vendor invoice(s) will be filed against the PO.
- Comments section: @ mention the partner invoicing A/R PoC to send invoice submission reminder
- Project Coordinators will set up Customer Folder in the Partner Folder, and include the following:
 - Partner Fully Executed SOW
 - Partner Invoice Tracking Sheet
 - Set up with SOW amount
 - Link Fully Executed SOW

Invoice Processing and Tracking

CURRENT PROCESS VIA COUPA:

- Project Coordinator receives notification from Coupa to review the partner submitted invoice.
 - Note - Approval queue is Consulting Project Coordinator first and Training Project Coordinator second.
- Project Coordinator reviews the invoice and Kantata timesheets to ensure accuracy of hours approved and rate.
- If the invoice and timesheets align, then the invoice is approved.
- If the invoice and timesheets do not align, then the invoice is returned to Accounts Payable, and the Project Coordinator follows up with the partner.
- Project Coordinator updates the partner invoice funds tracking sheet to include the invoice number, date, and amount and saves a copy of the invoice in the Partner Folder.

Sending Invoice Reminder to the Partner - each month end

- Within Kantata, go to Insights > Time & Expense Admin- Partners and then go to the Time Approvals by Project report.
- Enter the Date Range and filter the GitLab User Type field for the partner that you wish to view.
- Run the report, and export the report in Excel format by clicking on the gear icon on the top, right-hand side of the page and select Export to XLSX.
- Copy and paste the information into the applicable partner timesheet Google sheet. Template is provided in case you need to create a new sheet.
- Create a pdf version of the partner timesheet information.
- Send an email to the partner A/R point of contact using the template.

Making Engagement Epic and Issues Partner Accessible

Background

- PS automation creates engagement epics in Professional-Services-Group and issues in PS-Plan.
- It's useful to move the epics of engagements that require partner access to Professional-Servies-Group > Consulting Delivery

Notes

- Epics can not currently be moved so instead we recreate the epic in the new location, move the subordinate issues to the new location and close the original epic as described in Directions below.
- The original and new epics are linked via their issue move audit entries.
- The directions do not use a bulk edit due to this epic search issue.

Directions

- Open the to-be-recreated epic in a browser tab
- Open the destination epics list UI in another browser tab
 - New Epic
 - Title - Customer Name Customer Project Epic
 - Description - copy and paste description markdown from the original epic (current in the other browser tab)
 - Create epic
 - Put the url of the new epic in the copy paste buffer for use below
- For each issue in the to-be-recreated epic:
 - Browse to the issue
 - Use the /epic <url> slash command to move the issue to the new epic
 - e.g. /epic https://gitlab.com/groups/gitlab-com/customer-success/professional-services-group/ww-consulting/-/epics/2
 - To use a slash command, enter the text of the command in the comment interface and apply it with the Comment button

Kantata Processes

Kantata is our current Professional Services Automation (PSA) system. Follow the link below to view process steps.

Link to Kantata Processes

Kantata Reports

The Professional Services Team uses Kantata reports to track project and team metrics

Kantata Report List

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/professional-services-operations/mavenlink-processes/index.md

Mavenlink Processes

Mavenlink is our current PSA, follow the link below to view process steps and guidelines.

All other processes that relate to professional services operations can be found on the this page.

Mavenlink Log In

To log into Mavenlink, you will need to access GitLab's Okta account.

- Confirm access has been given to Mavenlink and Okta
- Click on Mavenlink inside Okta
- Verify email
- Enter password
- click "Sign On with Okta"

You should now be in Mavenlink, Enjoy!

Mavenlink Project Read/ Guest Access

With Guest Access, members can view information about a project without joining. Mavenlink members would have the same access as their permission set without being a project participant. However, they cannot comment, make changes, or interact with a project in any way. This is

useful for managers or administrators who want to view project information and check progress without being seen.

Although similar, here are some differences between members with View Only project access and those with Guest Access:

- Members with View Only access appear as allocatable project resources. With Guest Access, members can view project information without appearing as an option to be scheduled or allocated on a project.
 - Since they are not official project participants, guest viewers won't appear on the project as either the Provider or Client.
 - Guests are not tied to Account-level permissions; therefore, if a member has Collaborator account permissions and is assigned Guest Access at the Project Financials level, this member will have Project Financials view-only access.
 - Instead of using the API or manually assigning View Only access to one team member at a time, Access Groups allows you to assign Guest Access in bulk.
- Note: Members cannot be invited to a project as a guest viewer, they must be assigned Guest Access using Access Groups.
- A yellow notification banner at the top-right of the project indicates you are Viewing as Guest.

To view projects as Read only/ Guest:

- Members can find projects for which they have Guest Access by going to the Project List tab in Projects and selecting Guest Projects from the Show drop-down menu. Note that team members cannot have Guest Access on projects for which they're participating.

Mavenlink Update User Profile

- From the Dashboard, click on Edit Profile
- Update the profile information along with a photo and hit save

Mavenlink Collaborator (PSE) Onboarding Checklist

Account Configuration

- When you first enter Mavenlink, these are the items to review and update
- [] Update your profile
- [] Configure your email settings and notification preference
- [] Set your preferred default login screen

Daily Activities

- On a daily basis, you will do the following:

- ☐ Review Project Task Tracker
- ☐ Post messages, updates and files for project communication
- ☐ Track time
- ☐ Create, Log and submit expenses (Navan)

Weekly

- To ensure everything is up to date, review and/or update these items on a weekly basis.
- ☐ Review and submit your timesheet

Project Close

- These are the items to complete prior to close out your Project
- ☐ Ensure all your tasks are marked complete
- ☐ Confirm all time has been tracked in your timesheet
- ☐ Confirm all expenses have been logged and submitted

Mavenlink Project Lead, Project Manager Onboarding Checklist

Account Configuration

- When you first enter Mavenlink, these are the items to review and update:
- ☐ Update your profile
- ☐ Configure your email settings and notification preference
- ☐ Configure your default Project List view
- ☐ Configure your default Global Task Tracker view
- ☐ Set your preferred default login screen

Project Assignment

- When project is assigned, review the SOW along with the project details in Mavenlink to be sure there is an understanding of the project technical and financial details
- ☐ SOW
- ☐ Task Tracker
- ☐ Budget
- ☐ Custom Fields
- ☐ Billing & Revenue Rules
- ☐ Master Planning- Project Schedule
- ☐ Project Status
- Work through project set up:
 - ☐ Project Definition
 - ☐ Project Kick Off Deck
 - ☐ Project Folder
 - ☐ Project Internal Agenda
 - ☐ Slack Channels

Weekly- completed by EOD each Thursday

- To ensure everything is up to date, review and/or update these items on a weekly basis:
- ☐ Review and approve time sheets each Monday morning, approvals should be done by noon each

Monday

- ☐ Review project status and be sure it is up to date
 - Prospect- PC is setting up Mavenlink project/ Project is at a Stage 5- start reviewing staffing plan
 - In Set Up- PC is setting up Mavenlink project/ Reviewing Staffing/ Welcome to PS Email
 - Okay to Start- Project setup complete/ PM Planning the project
 - Active- PM/ PSE Actively working the project
 - Closed- Project work is complete, waiting for billing and revenue to be complete
 - Completed- Billing and Revenue is complete
 - On Hold- Project is delayed
 - Backlog- No work is planned
 - Cancelled- Project Created but will not be worked for various reasons
- ☐ Project Schedules- Master Planning, submitting updates
- ☐ Project Health Status
- ☐ Reviewing Forecast
- ☐ Project touch base call (if applies)
 - Could be internal call and/or customer call depending on project
- ☐ Project Definition/ Issue Tracking/Customer Updates

Project Close

- These are the items to complete prior to closing out a Project:
- ☐ Ensure all your tasks are marked complete
- ☐ Confirm all time has been tracked in your timesheet
- ☐ Confirm all expenses have been logged and submitted

Mavenlink Time Off Scheduling, Holidays, Family and Friends Days

Regional Holidays and Family and Friends Days

Regional holidays and Family and Friends days are included in Mavenlink on each members calendar, followed by the time off process. Since the days are included in the calendar there is no need to submit the time in the Mavenlink PTO feature or the users time sheet. When logging into the time sheet, the required work week is shown on the time sheet entry.

GitLab's company policy to submit time off is through Workday, and followed by this handbook process.

In the Professional Services group, we also require time off to be submitted to Mavenlink:

Benefits of having time off in Mavenlink

- Time is included on our Master Planning scheduling calendar
- This allows the PC and project managers to plan customer project around time off
- Ensures there is no conflicting customer project schedules

Process:

- When time-off is submitted to Workday, time-off is required to be submitted in Mavenlink as

well.

- Review the Master Planning to be sure a project is not already scheduled during the desired time off
- If project time is scheduled, review with the Project Coordinator if the project time could be moved or come to a mutual agreement for the requested time off

Time off would be submitted from the Dashboard, by clicking on the profile picture:

- GO to "Your Dashboard"
- Click on "Your Profile Picture"
- Right hand profile will pop up, there is a section for Upcoming Time Off
- Click on the plus sign to add time off

Time off cancellation

- GO to "Your Dashboard"
- Click on "Your Profile Picture"
- Right hand profile will pop up, there is a section for Upcoming Time Off
- Click on the plus sign select the date and update the hours to "0"

Mavenlink Time Tracking- Time Sheets

Mavenlink Time Approval Process

Overview

With Mavenlink's time approval functionality, members with Project Lead account permissions (or higher) can access the Time Approvals page where they can view and manage time for all projects in which they have Financials permissions (or higher).

The Time Approvals page allows you to view Submitted, Unsubmitted, and Rejected time entries from tabs with the corresponding names. Depending on the state of the submission, you can view the timesheet, private message a user who submitted time, and either approve or reject the time entry. You can also directly message those who still need to submit time, reminding them to do so.

If you have Report Viewer account permissions (or higher)-or have been designated as a Time Approver for an individual member or project-you'll see the Your Approvals check box. You can select this checkbox to only see the time that you're responsible for approving; otherwise, deselect it to review and take action on all submissions.

Members that do not have account permission of Report Viewer (or higher) will only be able to approve time in the project's Activity Feed.

Time Sheet Approvers

Project Type	Time Sheet Approver	Backup
Consulting Projects	Project Manager	Project Coordinator / Operations Analyst
Project Manager Hours	Arthur Foltz (EMEA PM's), Dani Arman (NA PM's)	Project Coordinator / Operations Analyst
Non Creditable Projects	Arthur Foltz (EMEA PM's), Dani Arman (NA PM's), Glen Miller (PSE's), Kevin Vogt (TA's), Sean Sandoval (Trainers)	Project Coordinator / Operations Analyst
Training Projects	Training Coordinator	Operations Analyst

Weekly Time Sheet Timelines

Time Sheet Submission	Time Sheet Approvals
Each Friday, EOD	Each Monday by 1 PM EST

Billing Period Time Sheet Timelines

Time Sheet Submission	Time Sheet Approvals
Wednesday by 5 PM	Thursday by 1 PM ET

Project Notes

- Notes are required for all Non Creditable time entries
- If the notes section is blank, reject the time sheet asking for project notes

There are 3 ways to approve timesheets via Mavenlink:

- Mavenlink email
- Mavenlink Time Sheet Approvals
- Mavenlink project activity feed

Method 1- Mavenlink email

- Automated Mavenlink time sheet approval email received when time sheet is submitted

- Click on the view the timesheet link to review the timesheet.
- Click the Approve button to approve the timesheet or the Reject button to reject the timesheet. Enter notes if you are rejecting the timesheet.

Method 2- Mavenlink Time Sheet Approvals

Method 3- Mavenlink project activity feed

Mavenlink Project Creation

When SFDC Opportunities reach a stage 5 status, there is a push to Mavenlink which creates the project.

There are steps to follow to update the Mavenlink project:

Responsible Role: PC

Prospect Projects

1. Review project opportunity and documentation.
 - PS Project- SOW
 - Training Project- Order Form or SOW if custom training purchased
2. Update the project status to Prospect.
3. Add the PS Operations Manager to the Mavenlink project.
4. Reassign the Mavenlink project lead to the assigned Project Coordinator.
5. Ensure that no dates are entered in the Task Tracker to prevent the project from being added to the forecast.

Closed, Won Projects

Once the PS Opportunity is closed/ won, a notification is sent from SFDC.

1. Review project opportunity and documentation
 - PS Project- SOW
 - Training Project- Order Form or SOW if custom training purchased
1. Update the project status to In Set Up
1. Review project settings:
 - Delete out the Start and End Date
 - Update project color
 - Update the project budget to match the budget of the opportunity, SOW or Order Form
 - Uncheck the include expenses box
 - Target Margin should be 40%
 - Update Rate Card
 - Update task billing mode
 - Update task default

- Review Organization to be sure it is set to GitLab

1. Update the Custom Fields

- Engagement Manager
- Add GitLab Project Link
- Security Requirements
- Project Components
- Billing Type
- Billing Terms
- Passice Acceptance Language
- Revenue Release

1. Review task tracker

- For Customer SOW, remove the task and ask the EM to push over the tasks to the Mavenlink project
- Once tasks are pushed over to the Mavenlink project, review task hours and milestone budget to be sure they are correct
- For SKUD offerings, review the task to be sure they match the SOW or Order form
- Also update the task details
 - PS Category
 - PS Type
 - PS Services

1. Be sure there are no start or due dates set in the task tracker

1. Add Unnamed resources in the Master Planning until resources have been selected

1. Add note in the activity section to include the following:

- SOW
- Order Form
- Link to Google drive

1. Review the contact section of the PS Opportunity and confirm with sales

1. Send the Welcome to PS Email to customer

- Training Template
- Consulting Project Template

Mavenlink Project Health Report

Project Health Reports are found on the Mavenlink project on the right hand fly out panel

Click On new Health Report to create a new report

Fill out each section and save

Only one Health Report can be added each day

Mavenlink Project Status/ Colors

Mavenlink Status	
Estimate- Gray	Projects that are tracking Internal time for GitLab PS & GitLab Partners
Prospect- Gray	PC is setting up Mavenlink project/ Project is at a Stage 5- start reviewing staffing plan
In Set Up- Gray	PC is setting up Mavenlink project/ Reviewing Staffing/ Welcome to PS Email
Okay to Start- Light Green	Project setup complete/ PM Planning the project
Active- Dark Green	PM/ PSE Actively working the project
Closed- Blue	Project work is complete, waiting for billing and revenue to be complete
Completed- Blue	Billing and Revenue is complete
On Hold- Gray	Project is delayed
Backlog- Gray	No work is planned
Cancelled- Blue	Project Created but will not be worked for various reasons

Mavenlink Project Colors	
Blue	Training Only Project
Yellow	Consulting Only Project
Orange	Consulting & Training Project
Lime	Internal Project

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PS Process & Methodology Mapped to the Customer Journey

The Professional Services process and methodology fits within the Customer journey that is supported by Customer Success. Professional Services contributes to the customer journey from the point of SOW Close through the Project Close phase.

Source, GitLab Team Members Only

PS Process Methodology Stages

The above diagram (slide 4) is meant to describe the Directly Responsible Individuals (DRIs), Activities, Outcomes, and Tools/Collateral for each stage of the methodology. We can also see clear categorization of stages in pre-sales and post-sales phases.

In the linked pages below, you can see a detailed drill down into the steps within each stage that individuals use to perform activities to deliver desired outcomes per each stage. These pages are split by the Phase of the selling process (Pre-sales vs Post-sales).

Pre-Sales Overview

The purpose of this page is to document the sales-assisted selling motion used by Professional Services Engagement Managers and Regional Delivery Managers. If you're on a GitLab sales account team looking for information, try these pages on positioning professional services or selling professional services.

This page will help outline the when and how to get involved with positioning and scoping services, how to estimate, how to use SOW generation software, and the processes to gain approval.

> Note: Services engagements can take two forms. This will focus on the custom SOW scoping process, not the Standard SKU process.

For custom SOWs, the workflow for SOW creation involves a partnership between the Account Team and the Professional Services Team.

Source, GitLab Team Members Only

1. Positioning

- DRI: Account Team (SAE/AE, SA, CSM)
- Supported By: Engagement Manager

MEDDPICC

Professional services can be positioned when a prospect becomes a customer (e.g. the Land of a new deal) or when an already existing customer is growing their staff or interesting in adopting new features of GitLab (e.g. expansion). The SA, SAE, AE, or CSM (e.g. "Account Team") is primarily responsible for this process, following the Command of the Message and MEDDPICC messaging frameworks.

For the larger, more strategic customers PS Engagement Managers tend to get involved earlier in the selling process to help with discovery and provide lessons learned on rollout from past engagements. For the medium sized customers, Engagement managers tend to get involved with account teams when the SFDC stage 4 (Proposal) is achieved.

PS Opp Qualification

As the overall subscription deal is progressing, the account team should begin to qualify in or out an attached professional services opportunity. They can do this with some simple scripts to first establish value of professional services. Next they should ask qualifying questions like:

1. How do you plan to execute the upcoming transition onto the GitLab platform?
1. Who will manage this, both from a technical perspective and a change management standpoint?
1. What will that person or people be de-prioritizing to drive this?
1. Have those people worked with the intricacies of such a transition in the past?
1. How do you plan to surface and manage risks throughout the transition period?

If the customer is uncertain to any of these questions, you can assert that it might make sense to bring in the PS Engagement Manager in to scope the engagement as an option to help derisk the rollout of GitLab and maximize the value/impact of the subscription purchase.

AE Creates PS Only Opp in SFDC

Once its identified that the customer will likely want to engage with professional services, its the responsibility of the Account Team to get in touch with the Engagement Manager.

2. Scoping

- DRI: Engagement Manager
- Supported By: PS Practice, Account Team (SAE/AE, SA, CSM)

Gather Data

After the services calculator is run by the Account Team, scoping issues and Project Scheduling Intake issues are automatically created and land in the PS Plan Project. Using this customer scoping issue and Project Scheduling Intake issue, the engagement manager gathers data asynchronously from the account team. Questions about the potential engagement can sometimes be answered by the Account Team from the discovery that was done already. We want to make sure we avoid asking duplicate questions to the customer. In some cases when the account team cannot provide the level of detail to create an egagement, the EM will meet with the Account team and Customer to ask additional discovery questions to get to a level of detail needed. Once the data has been gathered, the EM will populate the answers to the Project Scheduling Intake issue.

Create Engagement Estimate

A PS Engagement Estimate spreadsheet used for scoping services. The Engagement Manager uses the PS engagement estimate spreadsheet to define the services in scope and estimate the amount of time for each activity. There is a catalog of activities in the SOW generation automation project or a list of services can be found at our offerings framework page.

Iterate / Review Engagement Estimate

After the first iteration of building detail into the straw-man, the Engagement manager posts a request for review in the professional services slack channel to the Account team. Often the Engagement Manager will get on a zoom call with the customer and provide context and gather feedback from the customer.

Generate SOW

Once the Engagement Manager can get buy in from the account team and/or customer on the size and activities included in the services engagement, the SOW generation automation can be run using the straw-man as an input. The engagement manager is responsible for running this automation which can be done by following the instructions on the readme in the above project.

Iterate/Review SOW Data

Once the SOW is generated, it is ready for review by the account team. Iteration can occur here but should be minimized if the proper iteration was done on the Straw-man Steps.

SOW Review/Approval

After one or more rounds of iteration on feedback from the account team, the SOW will be ready for Review and Approval by Sr. Director of Professional Services. The review processes are signaled in the professional services slack channel and at-mention the GitLab engagement stakeholders.

3. Delivery Prep

- DRI: Project Manager
- Supported By: EM, PM, PSE, TA, Account Team

Once the engagement moves to stage 6, awaiting signature in salesforce, the engagement manager schedules an intro meeting between the PM and the customer stakeholder to discuss "how we manage projects at GitLab". During this call, the PM will also discuss resource assignment, and scheduling details. Simultaneously, the PM will schedule an internal transition meeting with the EM, PM, PSE, TA, and Account Team to review the technical discussions that occurred during the customer scoping meetings. This is a opportunity for the entire team to discuss and disclose the inner workings and dynamics of the customer project team.

PM Introduction

Engagement managers introduce the PS Project Manager as they are in contract with the customer during the scoping exercise and are perfectly positioned to do so.

Resource Identification

The PS Project Coordinator, working closely with the Regional Delivery Manager, will identify the best resource to deliver the project based on skillset, timezone, personality, tenure, and availability.

Project Prep call

This is a call between the customer stakeholder and the PS Project Manager to discuss HOW we work. Where we track project progress, what status report will look like, what the meeting cadence might be, a review of the contract terms that affect how we work such as minimum hours per week, expiration dates, delay language, and most importantly, how to achieve mutual agreement with the customer on a preliminary project schedule, prior to the kick-off call which includes the entire project team.

Check out the PS Delivery methodology to understand the details around pre-sales handoff to the delivery team, to ensure a successful relationship and productive engagement.

4. SOW Execution/Close

- DRI Engagement Manager
- Supported By: PS Leader, Sr. PSE, SAE/AE, Legal, Finance, Deal Desk

Finance Approval

The engagement manager can kick off the finance approval process in Salesforce. TODO: Add more details.

Legal Approval

The Engagement Manager is responsible for creating a Legal Approval Case in Salesforce from the associated opportunity. This process often involves reviewing and accepting redlines from the customer and from our legal team. The source of truth for the latest SOW is managed in the SFDC legal case. The EM should coordinate who "holds the pen" to ensure we maintain version control of the SOW with the latest redlines.

Customer Signature

Once the SOW has been approved by PS leadership, Legal and Revenue, the account team owns the process of executing the SOW. They should take the approved SOW from the legal case and route it for signature with the customer.

Deal Desk updates SFDC

Once the SOW is fully executed, the deal desk team updates the Salesforce PS-Only opportunity to closed-won.

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/project-mgmt/_index.md

- Project Initiate & Plan
 - Iteration 0
 - Initial Kantata Review
- Deliver, Train, and Monitor
 - Professional Services Delivery Methodology
 - Reporting Project Health & Forecasting
- Iterate and Validate
- Deploy & Close

Project Initiate & Plan

1. The Customer Epic, which is labeled as SOW + Customer, includes internal links to all relevant Customer & contract information. After obtaining Legal approval on a Professional Services contract, PS Quote triggers an Epic in GitLab.com around the recently sold Professional Services Project, at the Professional Services Group level.
2. Once a prospective Services deal reaches "Stage 6" (closing) in the PS Customer Journey, the PSOps team refers to the Customer Epic to find the "Scheduling Intake" issue. From this issue, the Resource Scheduling team works to gather the initial information needed to assign the PS Resources (PM, PSE, TA). This is where the PM is introduced to the Project.
3. Once assigned, the PM then reviews the Scheduling intake and begins to review/conduct the Sales to Delivery Transition phase.

Given the close collaboration between the PS Project Management and PS Operations team

functions, please refer to the PS Operations Wiki for more details on processes related to scheduling, reporting, billing, partner processes, and more.

Iteration 0

Iteration 0 includes the initial planning between the GitLab & Customer Project Teams. Proper Iteration 0 preparedness allows us to address risk and expectation early.

Summary of Iteration 0 Content:

Iteration 0 covers the critical preparatory phase of a project, including:

- Engagement Manager to PS Delivery Team transition process
- Setting up Support access for the Customer
- Conducting Stakeholder Planning sessions
- Organizing the Customer Kickoff meeting
- Running initial Discovery sessions with the Customer
- Establishing working agreements between teams
- Setting up the project communication plan
- Configuring the GitLab project structure (PM tooling)

Initial Kantata Review

Kantata is our primary Resource Management software. From here the PMO team reviews and manages the Delivery team hours against the Project scope in order to effectively report on Project progress with the Customer. This is also the primary mechanism for PS revenue forecasting. To ensure resources are allocated appropriately & our forecast is as accurate as possible, it's important to adhere to the schedule outlined above.

1. Once assigned to a project, make sure you, as the PM are assigned as the lead of the project in Kantata.
2. Go to Kantata > Resourcing > Resource Center > Projects and filter by Project Lead = you to review the allocations for your projects.
3. Go to Kantata > Resourcing > Resource Center > Team Members to see a specific resource(s) availability in case you need to change or increase allocations.
4. There are 2 types of bookings:
 - Soft bookings are non-confirmed allocations for team members (displayed as striped cells). This must be added by the PM.
 - Hard bookings are confirmed allocations (displayed as colored cells). This also, must be added by the PM.
5. To create a new resource request, navigate to the Resource Center > Projects. Under the list of assigned team members, you can click "Add Team Member" or "Add unnamed Resource", fill-in the information at the top of the pop-up and click "Submit Request". NB: Clicking "Post" will not submit the request.

Billable vs NonBillable information, please refer to Team Metrics page.

Deliver, Train, and Monitor

Professional Services Delivery Methodology

We follow the PSDM (Professional Services Delivery Methodology) for all our Professional Service Engagements. The PSDM is a comprehensive framework that covers:

- Managing Projects in GitLab as the single source of truth
- Managing Projects according to SOW format (Agile, Time and Materials, Fixed Price)
- Establishing Project Velocity and Iteration scheduling
- Setting up Agile ceremonies and processes
- Managing labels for effective project tracking
- Creating and maintaining status reports
- Setting up and utilizing RAID boards for risk management
- Conducting both Internal and Customer Retrospectives
- Adhering to Agile terminology and best practices
- Managing sprints/iterations for optimal delivery

Reporting Project Health & Forecasting

PMO/Ops Reporting Schedule

- The PS reporting schedule & month end timelines are pinned to the pspmo Slack channel for weekly update requirements
- The purpose of this schedule is to reference and understand the relationship between PMO updates to Projects (health, forecasts, timecards) and PS Operations (reports, resource scheduling). Goal is to ensure Project and Program Managers are updating Project forecast in a consistent and symbiotic way to support both our PS Ops teams, as well as communicate our PS Project Portfolio review across the GitLab organization.
- Time & Materials (T&M) projects are invoiced according to time submitted at the Project level.
- Fixed Fee projects (FF or FP) are invoiced at a Milestone schedule. So it's vital to ensure anticipated dates are added to Milestones within FF projects, and we get customer signoff before the billing period ends.
- Note While SKUs are one transaction, we track against hourly (T&M) billings (eg. Consulting Blocks & Dedicated Engineer Projects)

Forecasting Time and Materials (T&M) and Fixed Fee (FF)

Forecast allocations impact PS revenue forecast and team members availability, utilization and planning.

- Soft allocations are used when final schedule is not known yet, for visibility and planning. Soft allocation will not promise team member availability for a project, and will be considered upside forecast (assuming 40% accuracy).
- Hard allocations will promise team member availability, for the requested hours, once approved by the project coordinator. The allocated hours will also project into the revenue forecast (assuming 90-95% accuracy).
- If is too early to resource request a specific resource, but we have a rough anticipation of our project schedule, please hard schedule with "unnamed resource" as this helps us understand our capacity needs.
- To ensure forecast revenue is accurate go under Resource Center in Kantata:

1. Select "Project Tab" and filter via "My Projects"
2. Expand project you are allocating for so you can see all PS Engineers and yourself
3. Click on each team member's name and submit RR request via the "activity" window opened and assign to Project Coordinator as recipient

- If it's a FF project, we need to update the dates on the Milestones in order for it to reflect in our forecast:

1. Open your project and open the "Task Tracker" tab
2. Expand milestones
3. Update sign off date

How to Track Upside

- Upside is reviewed on a weekly, monthly and quarterly basis. There are four scenarios around when we need to track upside within our weekly revenue tracking sheet (which is pinned to our ps-pmo channel):

- If we are unable to confidently forecast the project resources 2 months out, we need to soft-book PSE/PM/TA time in Katata.
- If we have a pending CO that is not yet reflected in Katata, review with the PMO Manager the details.
- If we anticipate a Milestone date will be adjusted to complete in the quarter, but it has not yet been confirmed/verified.
- It is helpful to call upside out in the customer report. ex: can only soft-forecast "x" amount because of "y" restraints.

Weekly Forecast Call Prep

1. Updated by 8am EST Tuesday
2. Run "Remaining Funds to Forecast" report
 - Select project status
 - Sort by project lead/PM
3. Validate start/kickoff/end dates are populated in for all of your project tasks
4. Run your Forecast report and ensure it's accurate
5. Review any upside or pushes/changes in forecast with PMO Manager
6. Run the "Task Audit Report"
7. Run the Allocation report
 - Review all soft & hard bookings and look at all team members in light blue
 - Help to find work for these team members as they are under allocated!
8. Review all soft-bookings Allocation report
 - Select All roles
 - Select Full quarter
 - There should be no soft allocations for the current month unless the project has just kicked off
 - Ensure hard bookings are in place for all projects post kick-off

Professional Services Portfolio Report

- Updated by 8am EST Tuesday
- Update the following in the Notes section:
 1. 1-lined progress update

2. If there is an issue, what is the proposed action + timing of fix
3. If there is assistance needed
4. DRI & contributors
5. Internal temperature (R-Y-G) | Customer temperature (R-Y-G)
6. Link to RAID & Internal Customer Epic if Y/R (to review WE, CO, WaR)

Iterate and Validate

Managing to Project Scope Changes

Project scope for Professional Services is the outline of the work required to deliver a Service against the Customer use case. This includes an overview of the work to be delivered (scope definitions), duration, and resources (cost). All of which is included in the Statement of Work (SOW). If there is a change in project scope, the Project/Program Manager will follow the guidelines below to ensure we properly capture:

1. Change Order

- Change orders (CO) are common elements of Professional Services engagements that can modify the scope definitions, duration, or cost of an ongoing project. A change order issue and a change order template is created by the Project/Program Manager and communicated with the Engagement Manager and Account Team. It is always attached to the Internal Customer Epic Issue.

- Common project scope change scenarios:

- Does need a CO:

- Change of scope definitions where the project budget requires additional funds. The PM should work with the EM/Account Team to fill out the Change Order template. From here, the EM will create a new PS opportunity for the amount required to fulfill the scope change. A new Kantata project will then be created by the PSOps team.

- If an existing project is requested to be pushed out two months, with similar project activities and deliverables as the original scope, and the customer agrees to use the original SOW, a change order must be created and associated with a new PS opportunity that reflects the extension.

- If the Project moves from T&M to FF (or vice versa).

- If you feel the Project needs a CO (especially on FF projects).

- Does not need a CO:

- If there is a change of project scope definitions within the SOW duration and budget, no change order is needed. The PM must get written confirmation with the Customer on the change of Scope definitions. This written confirmation must be screenshot & attached to the associated Project Epic.

- For extensions less than 2 months past the SOW expiration, the PM should capture written confirmation (from email or Slack) and attach the confirmation to the "Scope Engagement and Write SoW" issue found within the customer Epic.

2. Work at Risk (WaR)

- A WaR issue serves as a means to gain approval from PS leadership to commence project staffing or initiation before all paperwork is finalized. This approval is necessary whenever there's a requirement to commit to project start dates before the opportunity is completely closed. It's essential for both consulting and training projects. The responsibility for initiating WaR lies with the assigned Project or Program Manager with the EM/AE teams. This will enable the Delivery team to start staffing the project promptly. When seeking approval for

Work at Risk, please follow the steps outlined in the WaR template above.

- A WaR is not billed to the customer until after the contract is signed.
- Common scenarios:
 - Kicking off a project before SOW is signed by the Customer.
 - Resuming work before the CO is signed by the Customer, or the change is captured in writing.

3. Work Exception (WE)

- A Work Exception is used by a PM when seeking approval for a project to exceed the hours/budget originally allotted. Navigate to the PS-Plan project, add a new issue and select/follow the Work Exception issue template to gain approvals from PS leadership. It can be used independently or including a CO.
- Be sure close out work exception issues at the end of each quarter to assure proper quarterly accounting.
- Adding labels & detail within the issue as a PM is crucial, as this is how we will work to improve our internal PS processes.

Deploy & Close

1. Project Closure/Retrospective Meeting

Schedule a 30-minute meeting with the customer's point of contact (POC) to review the external project retrospective. It's recommended the team leverages the retrospective issue template within the Customer Project (CP) within Gitlab, and act as living issue throughout the project, allowing both teams to collaborate and update it regularly. During the closure meeting, this retrospective will serve as the primary agenda and a reliable source for capturing customer feedback. The meeting should cover key successes, challenges, and areas for improvement.

2. CSAT Survey

Before the project closure meeting, send the Customer Satisfaction (CSAT) Engagement Survey to gather formal feedback. A template or example communication for this can be found [here](#). The CSAT survey provides insights into customer satisfaction and highlights areas for future improvement.

3. Revenue Sign Off

Revenue Release T&M Projects

- Revenue is recognized and released at the end of each month.
- Project hours must be logged weekly via the time sheet function in Kantata. Professional Services Engineers (PSEs) or Project Managers (PMs) log time against the project, and the Project Lead or PM approves these entries weekly.
- At the end of each month, the Project Coordinator (PC) compiles all approved timesheets and submits the consolidated report to Finance for review and revenue release.

Revenue Release FP Projects

- Revenue is recognized upon receipt of customer milestone acceptance or upon the completion

of passive acceptance (according to the SOW terms).

- The PM makes a copy of the Project Milestone/Closure document and attaches the document to the Customer for closure, copying Operations coordinator. The Customer can either sign the document itself or reply "approved".

- Once approved, The PM updates set the Milestone in Kantata to "complete".

- If passive acceptance is applicable per the SOW, the Customer has 5 business days to approve or deny before we can set the milestone to "complete". Day 1 is counted as the day the notification is sent.

Key Updates for Kantata

- Within all respective Milestone tasks, complete the following:

- Sign-Off Sent: Update this custom field when the acceptance request email is sent.

- Sign-Off Received: Update this custom field when customer acceptance is received or passive acceptance is achieved. Attach the acceptance email (in PDF form) to the milestone.

- Passive Acceptance Utilized: If passive acceptance is used, update this field accordingly.

- For both acceptance scenarios, attach the acceptance email or milestone document to the milestone.

- Update actual start/kickoff/end dates

Note: Only top-level milestone fields should be updated. Sub-activities within the milestone remain unchanged.

4. Internal Project Retrospective

Schedule an internal project retrospective meeting with the GitLab Account Team, GitLab PS Project Team, Engagement Manager, and Delivery Managers, TA, and Practice team. The internal retrospective is essential for documenting lessons learned, scoping insights, and opportunities for continuous improvement.

5. Kantata Updates

Once the project is fully completed, with all hours submitted and accounted for, and milestone acceptance confirmed (for fixed-price projects), update the project status in Kantata to "Completed".

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/technical-architect/index.md

Who We Are

The Professional Services Technical Architect (TA) team at GitLab consists of highly skilled experts responsible for providing technical leadership, presales support, delivery oversight, and fostering collaboration across functional roles. With deep knowledge of GitLab's platform, DevOps practices, and industry best practices, we work closely with customers to understand their unique challenges and provide tailored solutions aligned with their business goals. Our team bridges the gap between technical and non-technical stakeholders ensuring clear communication and alignment throughout the scoping process and engagements. We continuously seek ways to improve our services, deliver exceptional value, and enable customers to maximize

the benefits of the GitLab platform for their DevOps transformation Journey.

Pre-Sales Support

Collaboration:

The TA team assists Account Teams (e.g. Account Executives, Solution Architects, Customer Success Managers, and Engagement Managers) with technical sales by following the MEDDPICC sales qualification methodology, acting as a trusted advisor during the scoping process, and providing Engagement Managers with strategic technical solutions to enhance the Customer Journey to full platform adoption.

Expert Technical Assistance to Engagement Managers

Technical Guidance and Solution Design:

- Understand the Customer Journey
- Understand common customer change management workflows and incorporate security, compliance and observability into customer engagements.
- Assist the Engagement Managers in scoping the technical challenges that the customer is currently encountering.
- Approve Statements of Work (SOW) including deliverables and level of effort.

Engage with an Architect

General Rules of Engagement

1. It is the EM's responsibility to gather information about the potential opportunity prior to engaging the TA. This includes:

- Ensuring the customer understands the value of the PS team, what we can offer, and how we can generally help customers drive value realization from their GitLab subscription purchase.
- Positioning what we want to do 80% of the time in general ways, avoiding detailed technical scoping until necessary.
- Helping align customer expectations with practical solutions before involving TA's.

1. In order for an Engagement Manager (EM) to engage with a TA, there should be an SFDC opportunity and scoping issue created. Additionally, in the scoping issue, the EM should be able to articulate the current customer pain points and technical or organizational constraints. If these are not present, the TA can push back on the EM to gather this information prior to joining internal or customer-facing calls.

Establish Subject Matter Expertise

TA's Leverage their expertise to build trust and demonstrate the value of GitLab services in achieving desired outcomes. They can help navigate challenging customer scenarios while continually communicating the value of GitLab services.

Helping with Discovery Calls

Support effective discovery sessions to gather detailed requirements and insights.

Role of EM:

- Act as the facilitator, asking higher-level questions to guide the discussion.

Role of TA:

- Ask more detailed, technical questions, to ensure all necessary information is gathered for successful project planning.
- Clarify technical requirements and constraints, and document technical dependencies.
- Identify potential risks and challenges early in the discovery process.
- Provide insights on best practices and suggest innovative solutions based on past experiences.
- Ensure all technical aspects are comprehensively understood, documented, agreed upon, and aligned to avoid creep and misunderstandings later in the project.

Estimating Level of Effort (LOE) and Required Scope

Accurately determine the resources and time needed for the project.

Role of TA:

- Collaborate with EMs to figure out the LOE.
- Account for potential risks and develop a comprehensive scope of work.
- Utilize experience and technical knowledge to provide accurate estimates and assumptions.

Helping Deliver Technical Details During Proposal

Ensure proposals are detailed and credible.

Role of EM:

- Lead the presentation of overall value proposition, timeline, cost, and schedule.

Role of TA:

- Add detailed technical insights, past customer experiences, and tribal knowledge.
- Substantiate the proposed plan and reinforce its feasibility and value.

Scoping and Planning Guidelines

Preparation:

- Reach out to your assigned TA with at least one business day notice using the PS and Sales team mapping
- Provide relevant context, notes, and information needed for the scoping call, including business challenges and desired outcomes.
- If the TA assigned does not specialize in the topics discussed on the customer call, they are responsible for coordinating with the TA team to identify a suitable expert.
- If the assigned TA is unable to help find an alternative, redirect your request to ps-ta-ama

Scoping Related Questions

Process:

- Add the label Scoping::NeedsTAAssistance to related GitLab issues with a clear request in the comments for TA follow-up.
- Update the label to Scoping::TAAssisted to when there are no outstanding questions in the issue.

Approvals and Review

Review Process:

- Add the TA::Needs-Review label to any SOWs not previously reviewed by a TA.
- Technical Architects will review within two business days, clarifying actions, assumptions, and deliverables.
- The TA::Approved label will be added once the SOW is reviewed and approved.

General Inquiries and Discussions

Communication:

- Use the ps-ta-ama channel on Slack for broader technical questions or role-related inquiries.
- Conduct discussions related to ongoing SOWs within the comments of the associated scoping issue to maintain context.

Project Technical Leadership

Responsibilities:

- Act as a point of escalation to resolve critical issues quickly.
- Enable Professional Service Engineers and Partner Engineers to better understand the GitLab Platform and workflows.
- Transition from scoping to leading the delivery of larger engagements, such as transformations or multi-workstream projects.
- Focus on Discovery and clearing technical hurdles in engagements.
- Ensure that Delivery Kits are iterated on during Delivery.
- Collaborate with the PMO to ensure project status is up to date in line with our Delivery Methodology.

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/_index.md

Project Process

1. Manager, Professional Services: Once an SOW has been approved and moved for Closed Won, assign a Professional Services Engineer.
1. Manager, Professional Services: Send welcome e-mail
1. Professional Services Engineer: Begins project with processes defined here.

- Kick-off
 - Intake for AWS or on-prem
 - On-going project calls (external)
 - On-going internal project updates
 - Change request when required for scope changes
 - Project Summary
1. Professional Services Engineer: Starts financial wrap-up process.
 1. Manager, Professional Services: Schedule blameless post-mortem.

Quote to Sign-off Process

This is an overview of the entire process for a services engagement from discovery of the customer's needs to the sign-off from the customer.

See Professional Services Business Operations

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/process.md

Professional Services Engineering Workflows

Project Process

1. Manager, Professional Services: Once an SOW has been approved and moved for Closed Won, assign a Professional Services Engineer.
1. Manager, Professional Services: Send welcome e-mail
1. Professional Services Engineer: Begins project with processes defined here.

- Kick-off
- Intake for AWS or on-prem
- On-going project calls (external)
- On-going internal project updates
- Change request when required for scope changes
- Project Summary

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SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/artifacts/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/artifacts/after-action.md

The following reports are templates to be filed after a particular activity takes place. These reports should be distributed to, at a minimum, the customer's SAE, the customer's CSM, your manager and the customer's contacts where appropriate.

This report template should be used for

- On-Site After Action Reports
- Go-Live After Action Report
- Training After Action Report

Using Template

1. Create new issue in the Professional Services project
1. Select "After Action Report" template
1. Fill out the various details.

Template

markdown

Participants:

Customer

Goals

Outcomes

Next Steps

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/artifacts/arch-diagram.md

The following are reference architecture diagrams for various deployment methods of GitLab.

Cloud Providers

AWS

See High Availability on AWS

GCP

See GKE on GCP

On-prem

See GitLab Architecture Overview

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/intake/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/intake/aws.md

For technical intake of a customer using AWS, use this form template.

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/intake/on-prem.md

For technical intake of a customer using AWS, use this form template.

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/internal/15minute-standup.md

See Standing Calls

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/internal/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/internal/biz-ops.md

This page has been replaced by Selling professional services

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/internal/root-cause-

At the conclusion of each project, we will conduct a root cause analysis using the template below. The purpose of these is to identify areas for improvement, as well as wins to make sure to highlight. The team generally works on independent projects and with diverse customer groups, so mutual learning is important to how the Professional Services Engineering team lives up to the GitLab values of Collaboration and Iteration.

Scheduling a Root Cause Analysis

1. Create an issue.

1. Use the RCA. Changes to that template can be added as an MR to the Professional Services project.

1. Ensure that the Root Cause Analysis label is applied to the issue.

1. Create a calendar event for the root cause analysis, including a link the issue and this page.

- Include the Strategic Account Executive (SAE), Customer Success Manager (CSM), Professional Service Engineer (PSE), your manager, and any other interested GitLab parties.

Conducting a Root Cause Analysis

Each root causes analysis meeting should follow (roughly) this agenda here.

Agenda

Meeting Purpose

1. This is a blameless root causes analysis.

1. We will not focus on the past events as they pertain to "could've," "should've," etc. However, we can make suggestions for what to do "next time."

1. We will focus on reinforcing GitLab Values, specifically items such as

- Address behavior, but don't label people

- People are not their work Always make suggestions about examples of work, not the person. Say, "you didn't respond to my feedback about the design," instead of, "you never listen." And, when receiving feedback, keep in mind that feedback is the best way to improve and that others want to see you succeed.

- Directness is about being transparent with each other. We try to channel our inner Ben Horowitz by being both straightforward and kind. Feedback is always about your work and not your person. That doesn't mean it will be easy to give nor receive it.

- Say Thanks

- No ego Don't defend a point to win an argument or double-down on a mistake. You are not your work; you don't have to defend your point. You do have to search for the right answer with help from others.

- Make a proposal If you need to decide something as a team make a proposal instead of calling a meeting to get everyone's input. Having a proposal will be a much more effective use of everyone's time.

Discussion

1. Go through the root causes analysis.

- Identify key demographics for the engagement (customer contacts, GitLab team-members, dates, etc.)
- Ensure to update links to the SOW for this engagement as well as the customer folder on Google Drive
- Capture any remaining customer-facing action items and assign an owner

1. Lessons learned

- What went well?
- What went wrong?
- Any suggestions for next time

1. Assign any action items for implementing suggestions and create issues/MR as needed

1. Ensure any IaC lessons learned are created as an MR to the mainline IaC repository

Assign Action Items

All follow-up action items will be assigned to a team/individual before the end of the meeting. If the item is not going to be a top priority leaving the meeting, don't make it a follow up item.

Sources

- Google SRE Handbook
- SAFe Iteration Retrospectives

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/project-execution/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/project-execution/calls.md

Customer Facing

- At least once a week
- Include all stakeholders
- Manager, PS and SAE should be "optional"

Internal

- 15 minute standup
- CSM, SAE, IE(s), Manager, PS

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/project-execution/kick-off.md

The kick-off may be handled as part of the Welcome to GitLab call orchestrated by the GitLab Customer Success Manager. However, many times the implementation kick off will be an on-site engagement or one handled directly by the Professional Services Engineer. This template is for use in those cases.

- Kick-off Call Template

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/project-execution/sign-off.md

After the SOW, or a specific Milestone has been successfully delivered and completed, the customer will need to sign a Project sign off document. This should be sent by the Project Manager. To send a Project Sign off document:

1. Create a Project sign-off document for the Project or Milestone, based upon the Project Sign off template
1. Create an email using the message below and attach the new Project sign off document
1. Add the recipient who will be signing the document to the email and CC yourself and the PS Operations Manager
1. Update subject line to "[customer name]- project sign off
1. Send the email

text

Dear [Signer],

Attached you will find the project sign off documentation for your GitLab Professional Services Statement of Work.

Please sign the document and return at your earliest convenience. Alternatively, you may reply all with the word "accepted" and that will be accepted as sufficient approval as well.

If you have any questions, please feel free to reach out to let me know.

Thank you,
[your signature]

Once you receive the Project Sign off, via signed document or email acceptance, or passive acceptance, you'll need to follow these steps to process in Mavenlink

SECTION: customer-success/professional-services-engineering/workflows/project-

execution/welcome-email.md

This welcome e-mail will be sent by the Manager, Professional Services to introduce the customer to our Professional Services Engineering team and the concept of a GitLab implementation.

E-mail Template

text

Dear [Main Contact],

Let me add my welcome to GitLab, and extend our sincere desire to ensure that your GitLab implementation process is smooth and efficient, resulting in a system that will benefit your workflow, your software delivery process and thus your business. We look forward to working with [Customer Name] to make this project a success!

The most important next step in our process together is to identify key personnel on each side that will be dedicated to this project. Over the coming days, I will be working to identify a member of our dedicated Professional Services Engineering team to be the project lead for GitLab for your implementation. The GitLab Professional Services Engineer will work closely with the members of your team that will be working on this project.

The team members from [Customer Name] that will need to be identified to kick off the project include:

GitLab Champion - this individual will be the champion for GitLab at your organization

A GitLab Administrator(s) - this user or users will be the key lead for implementation decision making, system build, system management and aiding in coordinating resources from [Customer Name].

Technical POC - this user or users will help the GitLab Professional Services Engineering team gain the necessary technical resources and access to aid your team in the GitLab implementation.

Additional Stakeholders - please also identify any other stakeholders such as business and product stakeholders.

My team and I look forward to working with the team at [Customer Name], and we'll be in touch soon!

XXX XXX

Manager, Professional Services
GitLab

SECTION: customer-success/public-sector/_index.md

SECTION: customer-success/public-sector/solutions-architects.md

Solutions Architects (SA) who work with the Public Sector provide subject matter expertise and industry experience throughout the sales process to Public Sector customers within the United States.

Because specific requirements and common engagement practices differ from Enterprise or Commercial customers, the guidance below exists to assist Solutions Architects who work with customers in the Public Sector specifically.

Federal Support

The GitLab Support Team provides U.S.-based support for those customers that require U.S. citizens to work their support tickets.

- The user that submits the ticket needs to be associated with the appropriate account in SFDC.
- All accounts and user information get synched between SFDC and Zendesk on an hourly basis.
- All communications with support will be asynchronous, unless a synchronous call is requested by the Customer Success Manager and/or Solutions Architect for that account.
- Only customers designated as Public Sector in SFDC are eligible for Federal Support.
- When a Public Sector prospective customer begins a sales-assisted trial (including Proofs of Value), the Public Sector Solutions Architect will verify that the appropriate "Support Level" is set in the account record in SFDC (Premium or Ultimate). This will ensure that the SLA for support is set correctly.

Success Management Program Introduction

During each greenfield (new customer) sale, customers will move from the presales technical evaluation into procurement. During the presales period, the account sales team will introduce the Customer Success Management Program to eligible customers. This call will be led by the Solutions Architect. The introduction provides guidance on accessing GitLab Support, available CSM programs and GitLab Professional Services.

The goals of this introduction are many:

1. Smoothly transition the new customer to post-sales relationships for support, guidance, advocacy and growth
2. Ensure a smooth conversational shift from Go to Market use cases to DevOps stage adoption
3. Validate customer access to GitLab Support
4. Help the customer choose their level of CSM engagement after procurement
5. Ensure the customer understands available GitLab Professional Services and Enablement options

Program Flow

Prior to introducing the program, the SA should ensure that all sales stage data is recorded and available to kick off the Success Management Program. The required workflow within each sales stage is as follows:

Stages 0-2

- As discovery occurs in early sales stages, the Stage Technology fields on the Account record

in Salesforce should begin to be populated.

Stage 3

- During the technical evaluation, the SA should verify as much as possible about the use cases within the customer ecosystem.
- By the end of stage 3, all Use Case Technology fields on the Account record should be populated.

Stage 4-5

- Once the technical win is achieved, the GitLab Success Management data sheet (accessible by GitLab team members only) should be shared with the new customer.
- A call should be scheduled with the new customer and the sales team to introduce the Success Management Program as well as the Customer Success Manager, if the CSM introduction has not already happened during the technical evaluation.
- When the call is complete, the SA should log an activity of type 'call'